

1. Getting Familiar with RStudio

When you open RStudio, you will see several panels. Each panel has a different job.

At first, the screen may look busy. That is normal. You do not need to understand everything right away.

The RStudio Interface

RStudio usually has four main areas:

1. **Source Pane**
2. **Console**
3. **Environment Pane**
4. **Output Pane - Files / Plots / Packages / Help Pane**

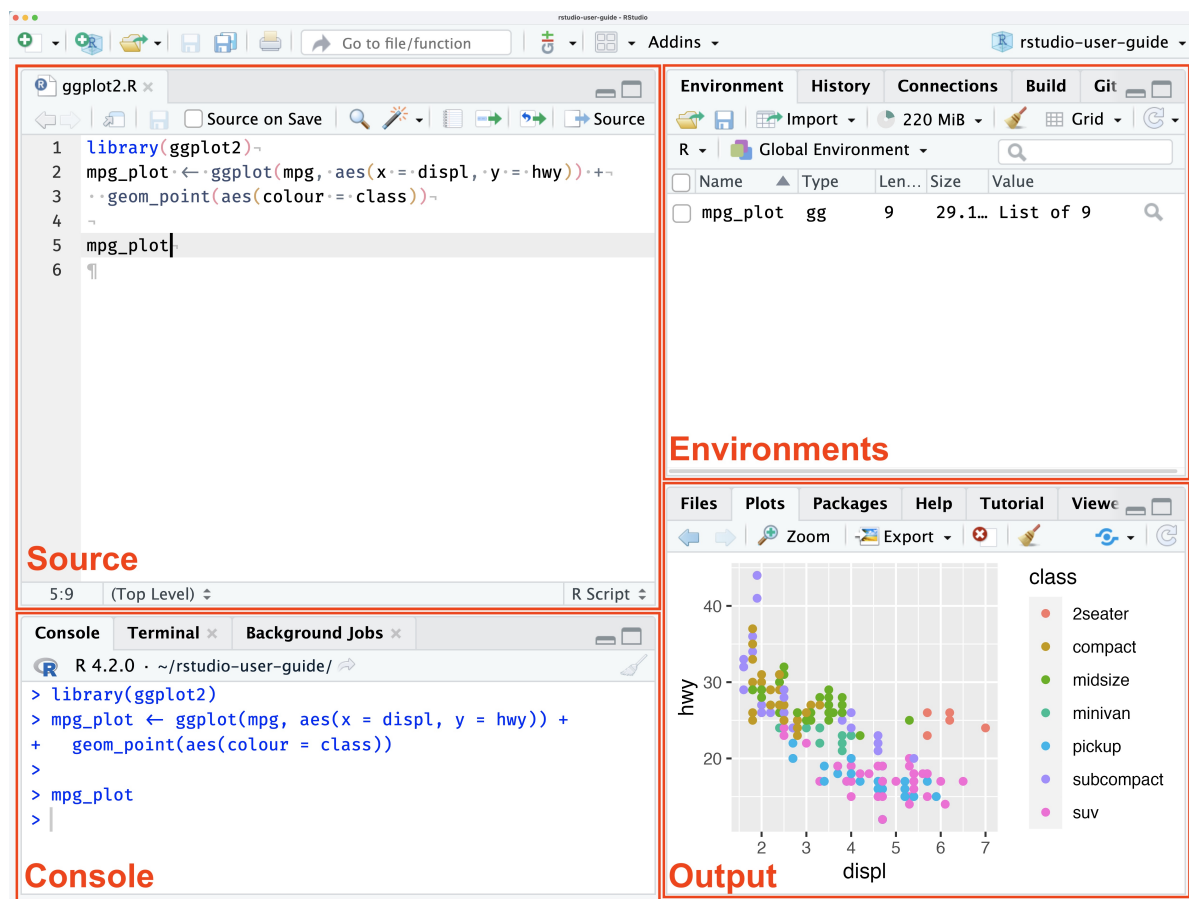


Figure 1: Source: Posit PBC documentation (<https://docs.posit.co/ide/user/ide/get-started/>)

Source Pane

The **Source Pane** is where you write and save code.

You will usually write your code in a file called an **R script**. R scripts end with **.R**.

Example file name:

```
first_script.R
```

The Source Pane is useful because it lets you save your work and come back to it later.

Tip

The Source Pane is like a notebook for your code.

Console

The **Console** is where R runs commands.

You can type code directly into the Console and press Enter.

For example:

```
2 + 2
```

R will show the answer:

```
[1] 4
```

The Console is useful for quick tests, but you usually should save important code in an R script.

Common Mistake

Do not only type important work into the Console. If you close RStudio, that code may be hard to find later.

Use an R script to save your work.

Environment Pane

The **Environment Pane** shows objects you have created.

An object is something stored in R, such as a number, a word, or a dataset.

For example, if you run:

```
score <- 95
```

You should see `score` appear in the Environment Pane.

Files / Plots / Packages / Help Pane

This pane has several useful tabs.

Files

The **Files** tab shows folders and files on your computer.

You can use it to find your project folder and open files.

Plots

The **Plots** tab shows graphs that you create in R.

Packages

The **Packages** tab shows extra R tools that are installed.

A package is like an add-on for R.

Help

The **Help** tab lets you search for information about R commands.

For example, you can search for help about the `mean()` function.

Try It Yourself

Practice

Open RStudio and try the following:

1. Find the Console.
2. Type this command:

```
10 + 5
```

3. Press Enter.
4. Look for the answer.
5. Find the Environment Pane.
6. Find the Files tab.

Check Your Understanding

Answer these questions in your own words:

1. Where do you write and save code?
2. Where does R show the results of commands?
3. Where can you see objects you created?
4. Where do plots appear?

Summary

In this section, you learned that RStudio has several main panes:

- The **Source Pane** is where you write and save code.
- The **Console** is where code runs and results appear.
- The **Environment Pane** shows objects you created.
- The **Files / Plots / Packages / Help Pane** helps you manage files, view graphs, use packages, and get help.